

» CHESS COLUMN

Memorable Merediths

By C.G.S.Narayanan

William Meredith, a distinguished American composer from Philadelphia, produced quality two-movers and set artistic standards in economy and content. Good Companion Club recognized this composer's efforts and instituted periodical tournaments for problems with a limit on the number of pieces between eight and twelve. In those times composers were sceptical to venture into trying the then modern themes with scant material but gradually made their foray into cross-check, half-pin, unpin etc and new merediths were churned out.

The first problem below is one from Good Companion Tourney which won premier honours hundred years ago. The content is well ahead of its times showing changed mates after two cross-checks.

D.Sielberger & Koetsheid

I Pr, Good Companion Meredith Ty 1919



Mate in two moves

Set: 1...Bc3+ 2.Kxc3

1...Bxc1+ 2.Kxc1

Key: 1.Qe6! waiting

1...Bc3+ 2.Nxc3; 1...Bxc1+ 2.Bxc1

and wealth of by-play

1...Bxe3 2.Rc2; 1...f3 2.Bxb5

1...b4 2.Qc4; 1...Be1 2.Bxf4

1...fxe3 2.Qg4

The key abandons the Q+K battery on the rank and forms Q+B battery

on file. There is wealth of by-play besides the two changes.

The second one by the renowned editor of The Problemist of the British Chess problem Society which features cross checks with a thematic key and subtle threat.

Barry P. Barnes

2 Prize, Evening News Ring Ty 1959



Mate in two moves

Key 1.Kb3! (2.Qb4)

1...Kd4 2.Nxc6; 1...Bxg5+ 2.fNd3

1...Bxf2+ 2.Nf3; 1...Bd4+ 2.eNd3

It looks a suicidal move by the white king. The bishop fires away with discovered check from the BRh3. but the white knights fire back with deadly accuracy.

The meredith below is for your solving pleasure.

M. Segers

I prize, Schachpelaran 1933



Mate in two moves

Solution to problem for solving in the article 'Vladimirov three-movers'

Key 1.Qa8! (2.c8Q+) changes mates for checks

changes the white responses to the same black checks –

1...Qh4+ 2.Bf6+ Ke4 3.Nd6#,

1...Qb4+ 2.Bd6+ Ke4 3.Ng5#,

Readers may send in their queries to
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